

"A woman must
have money
and a room ...
**if she is to
write fiction."**

VIRGINIA WOOLF, FROM *A ROOM OF ONE'S OWN*,
PUBLISHED IN 1929

A ROOM OF ONE'S OWN

Virginia Woolf, born in England in 1882, became famous as a writer of both novels and feminist texts—as well as for her relationship with her muse, Vita Sackville-West. In 1929, Woolf published an extended essay entitled *A Room of One's Own* based on two lectures she had recently given on the topic of women; the work went on to be a major feminist text with an enduring legacy. The essay explores many feminist issues, such as women's lack of education and their financial and social dependence on men. The "room" in Woolf's famous proclamation symbolized a space for independence, security, and privacy, all of which women had historically been denied the right to. Woolf is pictured here in her "writing lodge" at her home in Sussex, England.

